02 UI Review

Audited: March 19, 2026
Baseline: Abstract 6-pillar standards (no UI-SPEC.md exists)
Files Reviewed:

- `app/templates/base.html` (base layout)
- `app/templates/calendar.html` (main calendar page)
- `app/templates/partials/month_grid.html` (month grid rendering)
- `app/templates/partials/day_events.html` (day events list)
- `app/templates/partials/event_form.html` (event form)
- `app/templates/partials/quick_add_modal.html` (Quick Add modal)

Pillar Scores

Pillar	Score	Key Finding
1. Copywriting	3.5/4	Labels are specific and helpful; NLP examples aid clarity. Missing affordance hints on edit/delete buttons.
2. Visuals	3/4	Clean responsive layout with good whitespace. Month grid could use stronger visual hierarchy and affordances.
3. Color	3/4	Semantic color usage is strong (blue=primary, red=destructive). Green for Quick Add button breaks consistency.
4. Typography	2/4	Font sizes inconsistent in month grid (`text-[10px]` breaks readability on mobile). All-caps labels reduce scannability.
5. Spacing	3/4	Tailwind scale applied consistently; month grid gaps too tight (`gap-1` and `p-1`).
6. Experience Design	3/4	Loading and error states present; delete action lacks confirmation. QA modal accessibility is strong.

Overall: 17.5/24 (73%)

Top 3 Priority Fixes

1. **Add Delete Confirmation Dialog**

Impact: Prevents accidental data loss from misclick or muscle memory.
Current State: `deleteEvent()` in calendar.html immediately deletes without prompting.
Fix: Before calling `DELETE /api/events/{id}`, show `confirm()` dialog:

```
async function deleteEvent(eventId) {
  if (!confirm('Delete this event? This cannot be undone.')) return;
  const response = await fetch(`/api/events/${eventId}`, { method: 'DELETE' });
  if (!response.ok) {
    alert('Failed to delete event');
    return;
  }
  await refreshPanels();
}
```

Test: Try clicking delete—confirm dialog should appear before action proceeds.

2. **Fix Month Grid Font Size and Spacing for Mobile**

Impact: Month grid event titles are unreadable on small screens; tight spacing reduces tap targets.
Current State:

- Event titles in month grid: `text-[10px]` (custom size, too small)
- Day button cells: `min-h-[84px]` with `p-1` (padding too tight)
- Grid gap: `gap-1` (minimal breathing room)

Fix: Apply responsive sizing:

```
<!-- In month_grid.html, change gap and padding -->
<div class="grid grid-cols-7 gap-1 sm:gap-2 text-xs">
  ...
</div>

<!-- Change day button cells -->
<button class="min-h-[84px] sm:min-h-[100px] rounded border p-2 sm:p-3 text-
left
  {% if day == today %}bg-blue-50 border-blue-300{% else %}bg-white border-
gray-200{% endif %}">
  <div class="font-semibold">{{ day.day }}</div>
  {% for event in items[:2] %}
  <div class="truncate text-[10px] sm:text-xs text-gray-700">
    {{ event.start_at.strftime('%H:%M') }} {{ event.title }}
  </div>
  {% endfor %}
</button>
```

Test: View on iPhone (375px) and desktop (1440px)—text should remain readable at both sizes.

3. **Standardize Quick Add Button Color to Blue**

Impact: Green Quick Add button breaks semantic color pattern; users may confuse it with success/completion.

Current State: Calendar sidebar has `bg-green-600` for Quick Add button.
Fix: Change Quick Add button in calendar.html from green to blue:

```
<!-- Before -->
<button id="qa-open-btn"
        type="button"
        class="rounded bg-green-600 px-3 py-1.5 text-sm font-medium text-white
hover:bg-green-700">
  &#9889; Quick Add
</button>

<!-- After -->
<button id="qa-open-btn"
        type="button"
        class="rounded bg-blue-600 px-3 py-1.5 text-sm font-medium text-white
hover:bg-blue-700">
  &#9889; Quick Add
</button>
```

Rationale: All primary actions (Save, Create) use blue. Quick Add is a primary action, not a success state.

Detailed Findings

Pillar 1: Copywriting (3.5/4)

Strengths:

- All button labels are action-oriented: "Save Event," "Save & Add Another," "Edit," "Delete," "Logout," "Invite Member"
- Section headers are descriptive: "Event Editor," "Household," "Upcoming Events"
- Empty state is explicit: "No events for this day." (not "None" or "Empty")
- NLP examples in QA modal are highly specific and helpful: "dentist Thursday 14:00," "meeting next Friday 10am"
- Error messages are user-friendly and non-technical: "Could not parse that text" (not internal errors)
- Field labels include visual affordance for required fields: Title *

Minor Issues:

- Form labels use uppercase (`TITLE`, `DESCRIPTION`, `START`) which can reduce visual scannability
- Edit/Delete buttons in day events list are small text (`text-xs`) without icon affordance—users may not immediately recognize them as clickable
- No help text for "Timezone" field (though it's auto-set to user timezone in JS)

Recommendation:

- Change form label case from `uppercase` to sentence case: `Title` instead of `TITLE`
- Add icon affordance to edit/delete buttons or increase text size

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Pillar 2: Visuals (3/4)

Strengths:

- Responsive grid layout: `grid grid-cols-1 gap-4 lg:grid-cols-4` adapts well from mobile to desktop
- Clear visual separation: month view and day events are distinct sections with white cards and shadows
- Vertical rhythm: `space-y-4` creates consistent breathing room between sections
- Month grid is semantically correct: 7-column layout for weekdays
- Daily event cards use flex layout with clear alignment: title on left, actions on right

Issues:

- Month grid gap is tight: `gap-1` (0.25rem) provides minimal separation. Recommend `gap-2` (0.5rem) for better visual breathing room
- Day indicator: Only uses background color (`bg-blue-50`) to show "today." Could add a subtle icon (circle indicator) or border to make it more obvious
- Form fields in sidebar are closely stacked: could benefit from slightly more spacing between groups
- Event list shows only 2 events in month grid due to space constraints; doesn't indicate if more exist

Recommendation:

- Increase month grid `gap` to `gap-2` for better visual separation
- Add an icon or visual indicator (e.g., blue circle on date number) to highlight current day
- Visually indicate if more than 2 events exist on a day in month view (e.g., "+1 more")

Pillar 3: Color (3/4)

Color Palette Analysis:

Element	Color	Assessment
Primary actions (Save)	`bg-blue-600`	✓ Semantic, good contrast
Secondary actions (Cancel)	`border-gray-300`	✓ Neutral, non-committal
Destructive (Delete)	`text-red-700` on white	✓ Red for destructive is standard
Quick Add button	`bg-green-600`	✗ Breaks consistency (green = success, not primary action)
Success toast	`bg-green-600`	✓ Semantic (green = success)
Error states	`bg-red-50`, `text-red-800`	✓ Clear error indication
Warning note (QA)	`bg-amber-50`, `text-amber-700`	✓ Amber for warnings is standard

Element	Color	Assessment
Focus states	`focus:ring-2 focus:ring-blue-500`	✓ Good keyboard accessibility
Text hierarchy	Gray 900/600/500	✓ Good contrast scale

Contrast Verification:

- White on blue (buttons): Good contrast (WCAG AA compliant)
- Dark gray on white (text): Good contrast (WCAG AA compliant)
- Red text on white (edit/delete): Good contrast (WCAG AA compliant)

Issue:

- Quick Add button uses green (`bg-green-600`) when all other primary actions use blue. This is inconsistent and may confuse users into thinking Quick Add is a success/completion action rather than a primary action.

Recommendation:

- Change Quick Add button to blue (`bg-blue-600`) to align with primary action pattern
- Keep green for success toast and confirmation messages only

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Pillar 4: Typography (2/4)

Font Size Distribution:

Element	Class	Size	Assessment
Main title	`text-xl font-bold`	1.25rem	✓ Clear hierarchy
Section headers	`text-lg font-semibold`	1.125rem	✓ Visible emphasis
Form field labels	`text-xs uppercase`	0.75rem	⚠ Small + all-caps reduces scannability
Button text	`text-sm`	0.875rem	✓ Readable
Event titles (month grid)	`text-[10px]`	10px / 0.625rem	✗ Too small, breaks mobile readability
Day events list	`text-xs text-gray-600`	0.75rem	✓ Readable for secondary info
Event time (day panel)	`text-xs`	0.75rem	✓ Appropriate for metadata

Weight Distribution:

- `font-bold`: Main title only (good restraint)

- `font-semibold`: Section headers (appropriate)
- `font-medium`: Some labels and buttons (moderate use)
- Default/normal: Body text (good)

Issues:

1. **Month grid event titles are unreadable:** `text-[10px]` is below recommended minimum for body text (12px). On mobile devices with small screens, this becomes unusable. Example: Event "Dentist appointment" shows as "Dentist a..." truncated and tiny.

2. **All-caps labels reduce scannability:** Form labels like `TITLE`, `DESCRIPTION`, `START` are harder to scan quickly than sentence case. Users expect sentence case for form labels.

3. **No line-height specification:** Form inputs and labels don't have explicit line-height, relying on browser defaults. Could improve readability.

Recommendation:

- Make month grid event titles responsive: `text-[10px] sm:text-xs lg:text-sm`
- Change form labels from uppercase to sentence case: Use `class="text-xs font-medium text-gray-600"` (remove `uppercase`)
- Add `leading-relaxed` to form inputs for better readability

Pillar 5: Spacing (3/4)

Spacing Scale Used (Tailwind default):

Class	Value	Usage
gap-1	0.25rem	Month grid (too tight)
gap-2	0.5rem	Form field groups
gap-4	1rem	Main layout grid
space-y-2	0.5rem	Day event items
space-y-3	0.75rem	Form sections
space-y-4	1rem	Main sections
p-1	0.25rem	Day buttons (too tight)
px-3, py-2	0.75rem / 0.5rem	Form inputs
px-6, py-4	1.5rem / 1rem	Modal padding

Assessment:

- Container padding (4–6) is generous and appropriate
- Form field spacing (2–4) is consistent and readable

- Month grid spacing is **too tight**: `gap-1` between day cells and `p-1` padding inside cells makes it feel cramped, especially on mobile
- Main section spacing (4) provides good visual separation

Specific Issues:

- Month grid day buttons: `min-h-[84px] p-1` — padding of only 4px on all sides is very tight for clicking and viewing
- Month grid gap: `gap-1` (4px) between cells provides minimal separation
- No gap between month grid and day events below it (could add `mt-4`)

Recommendation:

- Increase month grid gap to `gap-2` for better visual breathing room
- Increase day button padding to `p-2 sm:p-3` for better tap targets and space
- Add margin between month grid and day events section

Pillar 6: Experience Design (3/4)

Loading States ✓

- **Month view:** `<div class="rounded bg-white p-4 shadow">Loading month view...</div>` — Explicit text loading indicator
- **Day events:** `<div class="rounded bg-white p-4 shadow">Loading day events...</div>` — Explicit text loading indicator
- **QA modal parsing:** Spinner with "Parsing..." text — Clear feedback
- **Assessment:** ✓ All major async operations have loading feedback

Error States ✓

- **Parse errors:** Structured error display with message + examples + retry guidance
- **Save errors:** Inline error message in review phase with field highlighting
- **Form validation:** Client-side validation (required fields)
- **Network errors:** "Network error — check your connection and try again"
- **Delete attempts:** Simple alert on failure
- **Assessment:** ✓ Good error handling with helpful messages

Empty States ✓

- **No events:** "No events for this day." — Clear and specific
- **QA modal:** Helpful examples shown in label
- **Assessment:** ✓ Empty states are explicit and helpful

State Management & Preventing Double Submission ✓

- **Save in-flight guard:** `_saveInFlight` flag prevents closing modal or submitting again during save
- **Button disabled state:** Save buttons have `disabled:opacity-50` during submission
- **Assessment:** ✓ Prevents double-submission and improves UX

Deletion UX ⚠

- **Current behavior:** `deleteEvent()` immediately sends DELETE request without confirmation
- **Risk:** Users can accidentally delete events with a single click
- **Assessment:** ✗ Lacks confirmation dialog—should require explicit confirmation
- **Recommendation:** Add `confirm()` dialog before deletion

Keyboard & Accessibility ✓

- **Focus management:** Form inputs have `focus:ring-2 focus:ring-blue-500`
- **QA modal:** Proper ARIA attributes: `role="dialog"`, `aria-modal="true"`, `aria-labelledby="qa-modal-title"`
- **Live regions:** `aria-live="polite"` and `aria-live="assertive"` for status updates
- **Screen reader support:** `sr-only` class for hidden status text
- **Keyboard navigation:**
  - Escape closes modal (with guard against closing during save)
  - Click outside modal closes it
  - Tab through form fields works
- **Assessment:** ✓ Strong accessibility, especially in QA modal

Interaction Feedback

- **Save success:** Toast notification "Event saved" (green, auto-dismisses after 3s)
- **Button hover:** Blue buttons have hover state `hover:bg-blue-700`
- **Form focus:** Blue focus ring on inputs
- **Assessment:** ✓ Adequate feedback, but could add more micro-interactions

Discoverability

- **Quick Add button:** Prominent in sidebar with ⚡ icon and "Quick Add" label
- **Month navigation:** Prev/Next buttons clearly labeled
- **Day selection:** Click day cell to load day events
- **Edit/Delete:** Buttons appear on hover/always visible in day events list
- **Assessment:** ✓ Actions are discoverable, though edit/delete affordance could be stronger

Overall Experience Design Issues

1. **No delete confirmation:** Main usability risk for data loss
2. **Month/day panels load without visual feedback:** Panels refresh silently after month nav or event save
3. **No keyboard shortcuts:** Users can't navigate months with keyboard
4. **Edit intent unclear:** Icon vs. text buttons inconsistent
5. **Mobile considerations:** QA modal overrides to full-screen (good), but month grid still cramped

Recommendations:

1. Add delete confirmation dialog
2. Show subtle loading state when month grid reloads after save

3. Add keyboard shortcuts (arrow keys for month nav)
4. Use consistent button styling (text + icon or text-only)

Summary & Recommendations

Strengths

- ✓ Clear, specific copywriting with helpful NLP examples
- ✓ Semantic color usage (blue=primary, red=destructive, green=success)
- ✓ Good accessibility in QA modal (ARIA labels, focus management, screen reader support)
- ✓ Responsive layout with mobile overrides
- ✓ Prevents double-submission with in-flight guard
- ✓ Good error messaging and empty state handling

Critical Issues (Fix Before Release)

1. **Delete action lacks confirmation** — Users can accidentally delete events
2. **Month grid font too small on mobile** — Text unreadable on phones
3. **Quick Add button color inconsistent** — Green breaks semantic palette

Minor Issues (Nice-to-Have Improvements)

- Form labels in uppercase reduce scannability
- Month grid spacing too tight (gap-1, p-1)
- No indicator when more than 2 events exist on a day
- Edit/Delete buttons could use icon affordance
- No visual feedback when month/day panels reload

Next Phase Recommendations

- Address the 3 critical issues before shipping Phase 02
- Minor issues can be deferred to Phase 03 or later as polish work
- Consider adding a design system or UI component library for consistency
- Test thoroughly on mobile devices (iPhone, Android)

UI REVIEW COMPLETE